

**DECODING
THE 2026
TAMIL NADU
ASSEMBLY
ELECTION**
Three Questions.
One Election.
Clear Insights.


Flip Story
How much
changed?


Regional Shift
Where did it
change?


Electoral Margin
How decisive
was change?


**AtliQ
Show**


**ECI
Data**
2021-2026


**Research
Focus**
What stories
deserve
airtime?


Method
SQL
+
Power BI

Q2 | Flip Story

Analytical Purpose

Track constituency-level winner realignment between 2021 and 2026.

Key Insight
Constituency Realignment



Q1 | Geographic Story

Analytical Purpose

How did seat distribution shift across Tamil Nadu's six regions between 2021 and 2026?

Key Insight
Regional Concentration



Q6 | Margin story

Analytical Purpose

Evaluate how decisive electoral outcomes became across seats.

Key Insight
Electoral Decisiveness



Research Question Selection

From six research directions, three were selected to construct one connected election narrative.



Why this Framework?

These questions examine the election through:

- Scale
- Distribution
- Intensity

No predictions.
No explanations.
Only measured outcomes.

Flip Story

Story 01 Constituency Realignment

How extensively did electoral control shift?

Tracking movement of winning formations between the 2021 and 2026 Assembly Elections across 234 constituencies.

234
Total
Constituencies

163
Flipped
Seats

71
Retained
Seats



163
Flipped Seats
69.66%

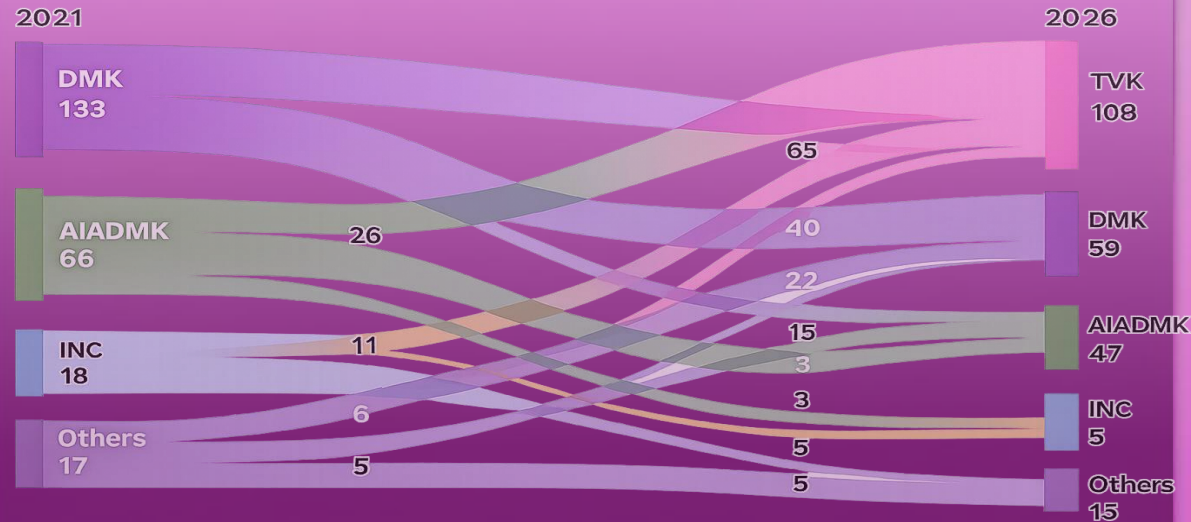


71
Retained Seats
30.34%

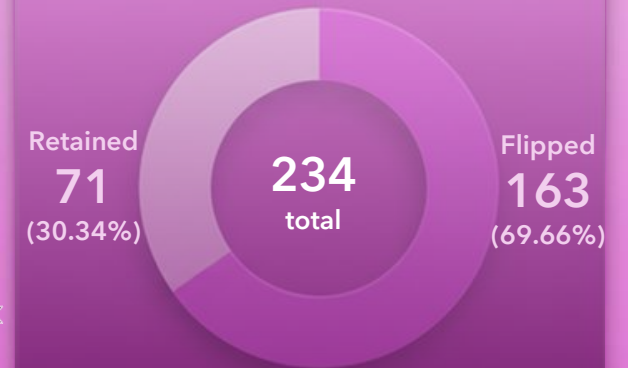


234
Total
Constituencies In
tamil nadu

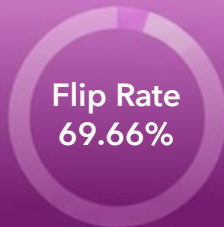
Winner Movement : 2021 → 2026



Retained VS Flipped



Nearly seven out of ten constituencies recorded a change in winning formation.

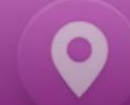


Largest Winner Flow
DMK → TVK



65
Constituencies

Most impacted region
Chennai Metro



93.8%
(30 / 32 constituencies
flipped)

Key Insight



Electoral movement was concentrated rather than evenly distributed across Tamil Nadu.



Source: ECI Results Portal (2026) / ECI Statistical Reports (2021) / Codebasics



2026 Election Results

Story 01 Findings

So What changed?

Examining how electoral control shifted between 2021 and 2026.

What we Observed?



The 2026 election was not a minor reshuffle.



163 out of 234 constituencies changed winning formation.



The movement was concentrated across selected formations rather than evenly distributed across all parties.



163

Flipped Seats
69.66%



71

Retained Seats
30.34%

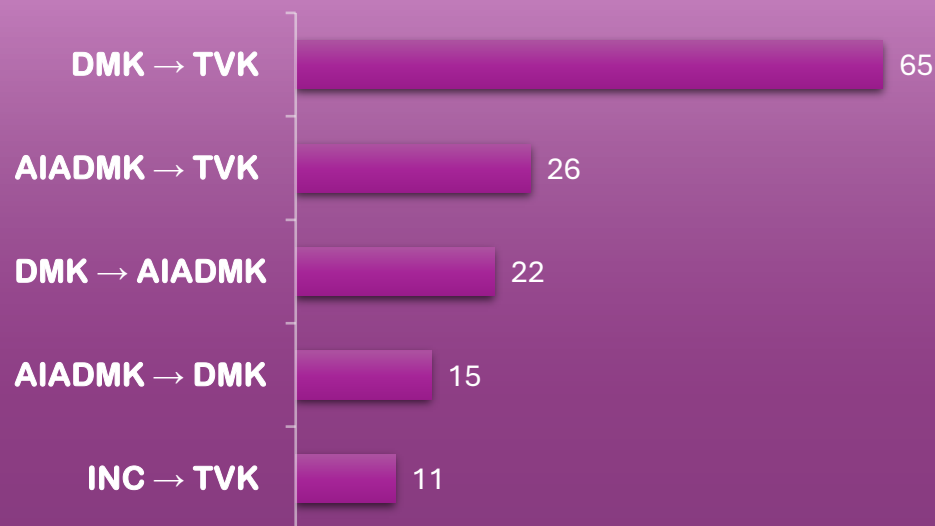


234

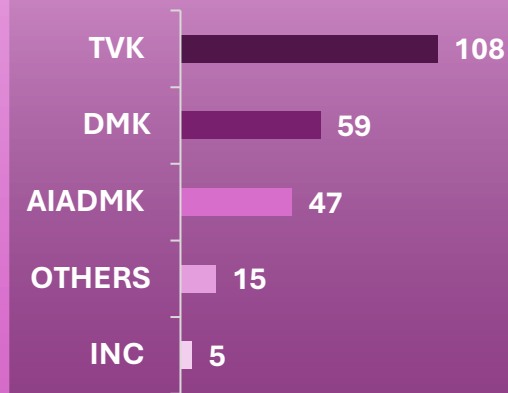
Total
Constituencies In
tamil nadu

Top Winner Transitions

Largest constituency movements between elections



Who Benefited Most?



Nearly seven out of ten constituencies recorded a change in winning formation.

Largest Winner Flow



Retained Base



71

Constituencies

retained their same
winning formation

Key Insight



The result was not a uniform transition.

Most movement concentrated in a few high-volume party shifts.

Geographic Story

Story 02 Geographic shift

Where was electoral
change concentrated?

What we Observed?



Change was not uniform
across the state.



Western and Northern regions
showed stronger movement.



TVK gained across regions.



163

Flipped Seats
69.66%



71

Retained Seats
30.34%

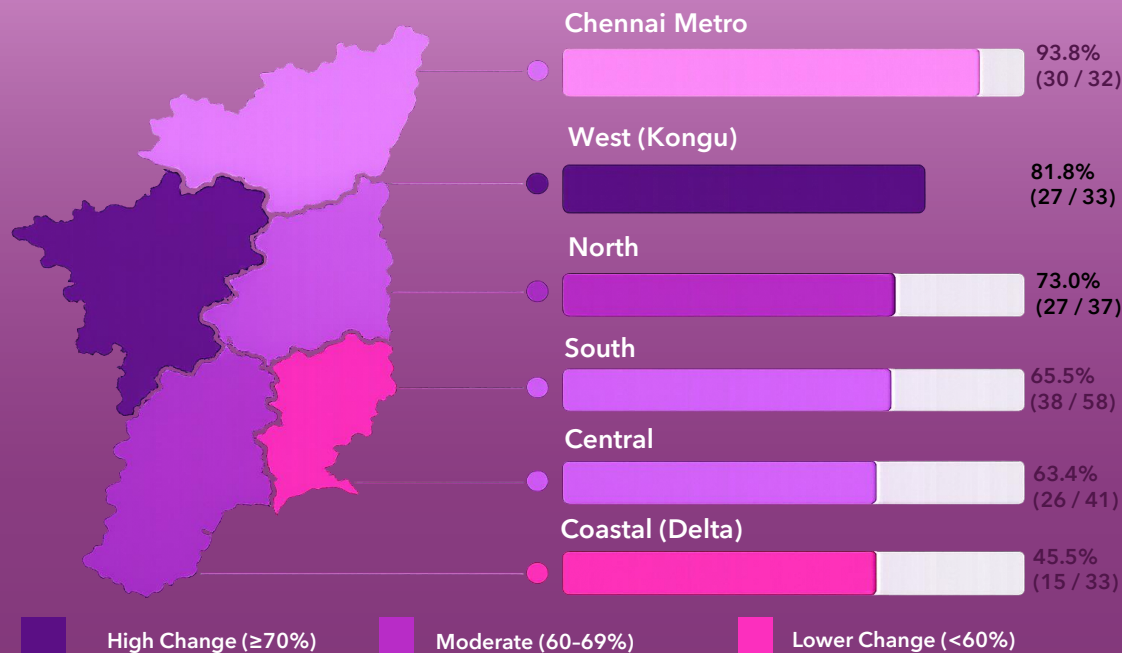


234

Total
Constituencies In tamil
nadu

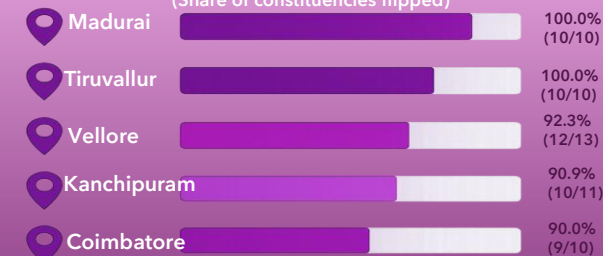
Regional Flip Intensity (2021 → 2026)

Share of constituencies that changed winning formation



Most volatile districts

(Share of constituencies flipped)



These districts saw the most
significant shifts in 2026.

Net Movement by region

(Which party gained the most)



TVK is the net gainer in all regions

Key takeaway



Electoral change was concentrated in
specific regions.
Kongu (West) and North recorded the
strongest shifts.
Coastal (Delta) remained relatively stable.

What this means



Regional dynamics played a
critical role in shaping the 2026
outcome.
Not every region moved in the
same way.

Why it Matters



Understanding regional
patterns helps decode the
drivers behind the
statewide result.

Geographic Story

Story 02 Findings

Who Controlled the Regions?

Understanding which parties benefited across regions.

What we Observed?



TVK emerged as the largest regional winner.



Delta remained more resistant to change.



AIADMK retained strength in selected territories.



6

Regions Analysed



3

Regions Led By TVK

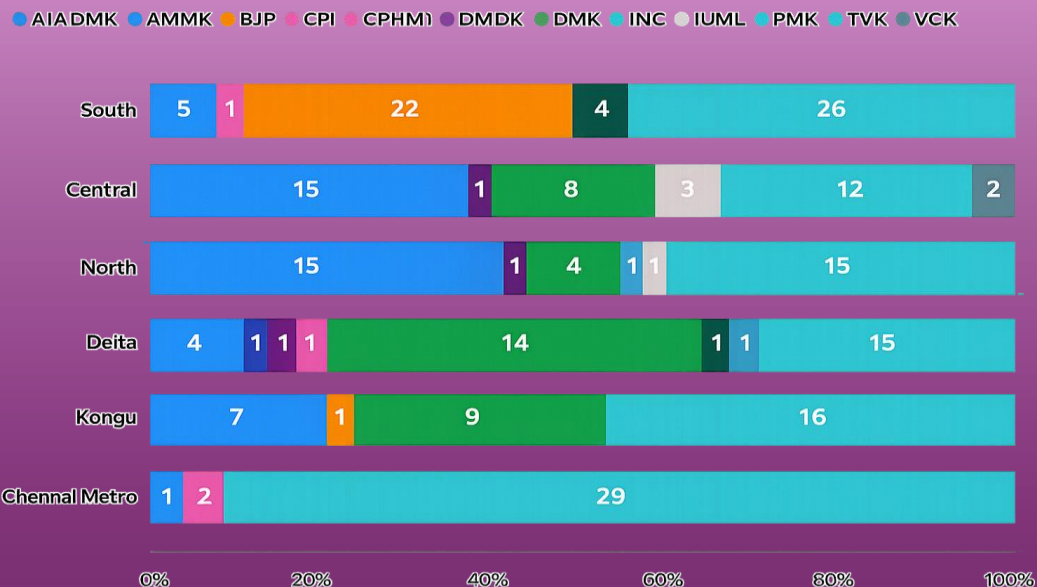


234

Total Seats Observed

Regional Party Dominance (2026)

Winning formation distribution by region



Leading Party By Region

Central	AIADMK	15
Chennai Metro	TVK	29
Delta	DMK	14
Kongu (West)	TVK	16
North	TVK/ AIADMK	15 (Tie)
South	TVK	26

Most Competitive Region



Lowest winner concentration

Region : North
Top share : 40.5%

Key takeaway



TVK became the dominant regional beneficiary, but gains were not uniform across Tamil Nadu.

What this means



Electoral concentration explains why statewide results alone can be misleading.

Why it Matters



Regional dynamics reveal where political momentum actually shifted.

Margin Story

Story 03
The Battlefield of
close Contests

Exploring where
elections were won
by narrow margins.

What we Observed?
Several constituencies
recorded extremely narrow
victory margins.

Close contests reveal where
voter preference shifted
most sharply.

Margin pressure was not
distributed uniformly.



10
Closest
Constituencies



1
Lowest
Margin(Votes)

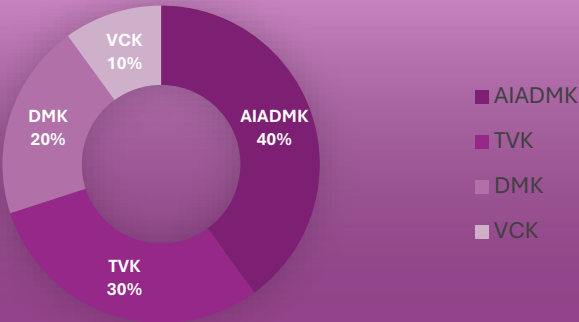


234
Seats
Analysed

Top 10 Closest Constituencies
Smallest victory margins in 2026

Rank	Constituency	Winner	Runner	Victory Margin	
1	Tiruppattur	TVK	DMK	1	
2	Veppanahalli	DMK	AIADMK	138	
3	Kanniyakumari	AIADMK	DMK	214	
4	Polur	TVK	DMDK	227	
5	Tirukkoyilur	AIADMK	TVK	285	
6	Paramathi-Velur	AIADMK	DMK	308	
7	Kulithalai	DMK	TVK	579	
8	Kumbakonam	TVK	DMK	679	
9	Palani	AIADMK	TVK	693	
10	Tindivanam	VCK	AIADMK	734	

Who won the Close battles?



Total: 10

Tightest Race



1
Vote

Key takeaway



Close constituencies highlight
where small vote swings
altered electoral outcomes.

What this means



Winning margins help identify
vulnerable political strongholds.

Why it Matters



Small margins signal potential
areas of future competition.

Margin Story

Story 03 Findings

What did the close battles reveal?

Understanding what narrow victories tell us about electoral pressure.

What we Observed?



Close battles were distributed across multiple parties.



Extremely small vote differences altered electoral outcomes.



Competitive seats may signal future battlegrounds.



10
Closest Seats



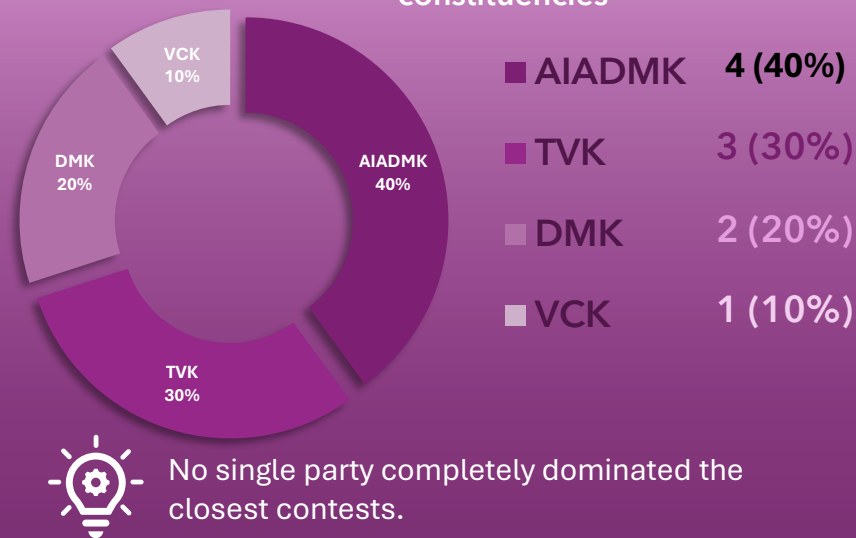
1
Lowest Margin(Votes)



734
Largest Margin Among Top 10

Close contest winner profile

Distribution of winners across the top 10 closest constituencies



Most competitive seats

Top 4 seats with the smallest victory margins

- 1 Tiruppattur **1** vote
- 2 Veppanahalli **138** votes
- 3 Kanniyakumari **214** votes
- 4 Polur **227** votes

Margins under 250 votes reflect intense competition.

Pressure index



40%

of the closest seats were captured by AIADMK.

Key takeaway



Competitive constituencies can act as early indicators of future electoral change.



What this means

Small vote swings materially changed electoral outcomes.



Why it Matters

Tracking close battles helps identify future competitive regions.

Connected Findings

What does the 2026 election tell us?

Bringing together the key stories from the 2026 Tamil Nadu election.

The Big Picture



Large-scale constituency realignment reshaped the electoral landscape.



Electoral movement was concentrated in specific regions and districts.



Several seats were won through extremely narrow victory margins.



163
Flipped Seats

Out of 234 constituencies



69.66%
Statewide Shift Rate

Constituencies that changed



1
Closest Victory Margin

Among the top 10 closest
seats

How the 2026 election story connects

Story 1



Constituency
Realignment

163 constituencies
changed winning
formation.



TVK emerged
as the largest
beneficiary,
gaining 65
seats from
DMK.

Story 2



Geographic
Shift

Electoral movement was
concentrated in specific
regions.



Chennai Metro
(93.8%)
and Kongu
(81.8%)
recorded the
highest shifts.

Story 3



Close Battles

Several seats were won
through extremely narrow
victory margins.



Among the
closest 10
seats, AIADMK
secured 4
wins.



Key Insight

Together, these factors
reshaped the political
landscape **beyond**
overall seat counts



Key Takeaway

Winning elections is not
only about total seats , it
also matters where those
seats were won and how
closely.



Future Outlook

Future elections may be
influenced by the same
high-movement regions
and **competitive** pockets.

Synthesis



Tamil Nadu's 2026 election combined
constituency movement, regional
concentration , and intense competition.



- ✓ Movement was real and significant
- ✓ Change was concentrated , not uniform
- ✓ Margins revealed high competitiveness

Conclusion

Beyond the numbers

Key reflections from the 2026 Tamil Nadu Electoral Analysis.



Election outcomes are shaped not only by seat totals but by where those seats shift.



Regional concentration revealed patterns that state wide summaries cannot fully explain.



Close contests highlighted constituencies that may shape future elections.



163
Seats Changed



69.66%
State wide Shift



1
Smallest Winning Margin

Final Editorial



The 2026 Tamil Nadu election was not defined by a uniform wave across the state.



Instead, change occurred through concentrated regional movement and competitive constituencies.



Understanding these local patterns provides deeper insight than statewide seat counts alone.

Key Learnings



Constituency movement explains **who** gained.



Regional analysis explains **where** change occurred.



Margin analysis explains **how** stable those outcomes are.

What this means



Regional and constituency analysis provides deeper insight than state wide seat totals alone.

Editorial Recommendation

Focus future election analysis on regions with high seat movement and constituencies with narrow victory margins.

Regional concentration and competitive seats provide stronger signals than state wide totals alone.

Data Limitations

This analysis focuses on seat movement and election outcomes. Turnout drivers , demographic effects ,and candidate-level factors were not included.